

PARK in a TRUCK

POLLINATOR PLANTING

W O R K B O O K



A do-it-yourself toolkit for neighborhood parks

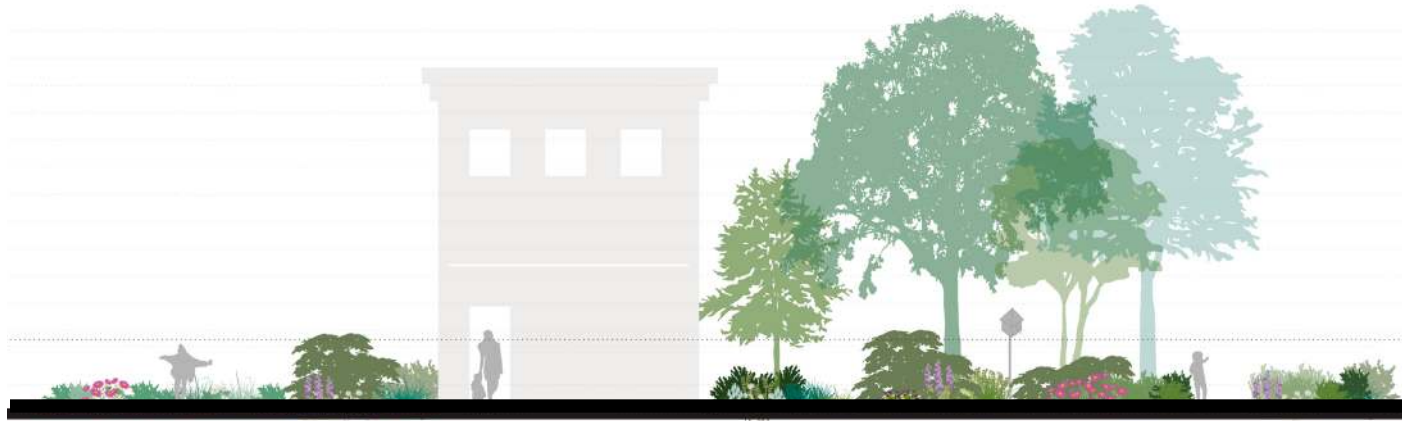
The Landscape Architecture Program +
The Lab for Social and Urban Innovation
Thomas Jefferson University
Philadelphia, PA

Welcome to the Pollinator Planting Patch Workbook! This guide is designed so that if you simply have an area you’d like to plant and know its dimensions, you can plant a pollinator garden! We’ll guide you through a few questions to help you get started on your planting project!

PLANTING PATCH CONTENTS

- OVERVIEW
- PLANTING AREA
- WHAT TO PLANT
- PLANT TYPES - PLANT LIST
- EXAMPLE PLANTING PLANS
- COST ESTIMATE
- GENERAL GUIDELINES FOR PLANTING
- GENERAL GUIDELINES FOR MAINTENANCE

This workbook explains how to add pollinator plants to any location, but also how to add plants to your park!



OVERVIEW

Welcome to the Pollinator Planting Patch Workbook—your green companion on the journey to transform any space into a lush paradise, whether it’s a sprawling park or a cozy nook. Ready to sprinkle some magic and turn your neighborhood into a native plant wonderland and boost pollinator habitat? We’ve got your back, so let’s dive in!

Planting native plants for pollinators brings a host of benefits:

Biodiversity Boost:

Supports local wildlife by providing food, shelter, and breeding grounds.

Adaptation to Local Conditions:

Thrives in specific climates, reducing the need for excessive water and chemicals.

Water Conservation:

Well-suited to local rainfall patterns, requiring less water once established.

Pollinator Magnet:

Attracts and supports local pollinators crucial for plant and crop pollination.

Low Maintenance:

Hardy and resistant to pests, reducing the need for extensive maintenance.

Soil Health:

Improves soil health and prevents erosion.

Aesthetic Appeal:

Offers unique and beautiful aesthetics for gardens and landscapes.

Cultural Significance:

Preserves local cultural and historical heritage.

Invasive Species Control:

Reduces the risk of invasive species taking over local ecosystems.

Climate Change Resilience:

Supports ecosystems better adapted to local climatic conditions.

In essence, planting native plants is a sustainable choice that promotes local ecology and provides a range of benefits for both the environment and gardeners.



PLANT AREA - PATCH

To get started, assess the area you want to plant using your “Base Plan” or, if you don’t have one, estimate the square footage you wish to dedicate to planting.

SIZE

How long is your patch?

SIZE

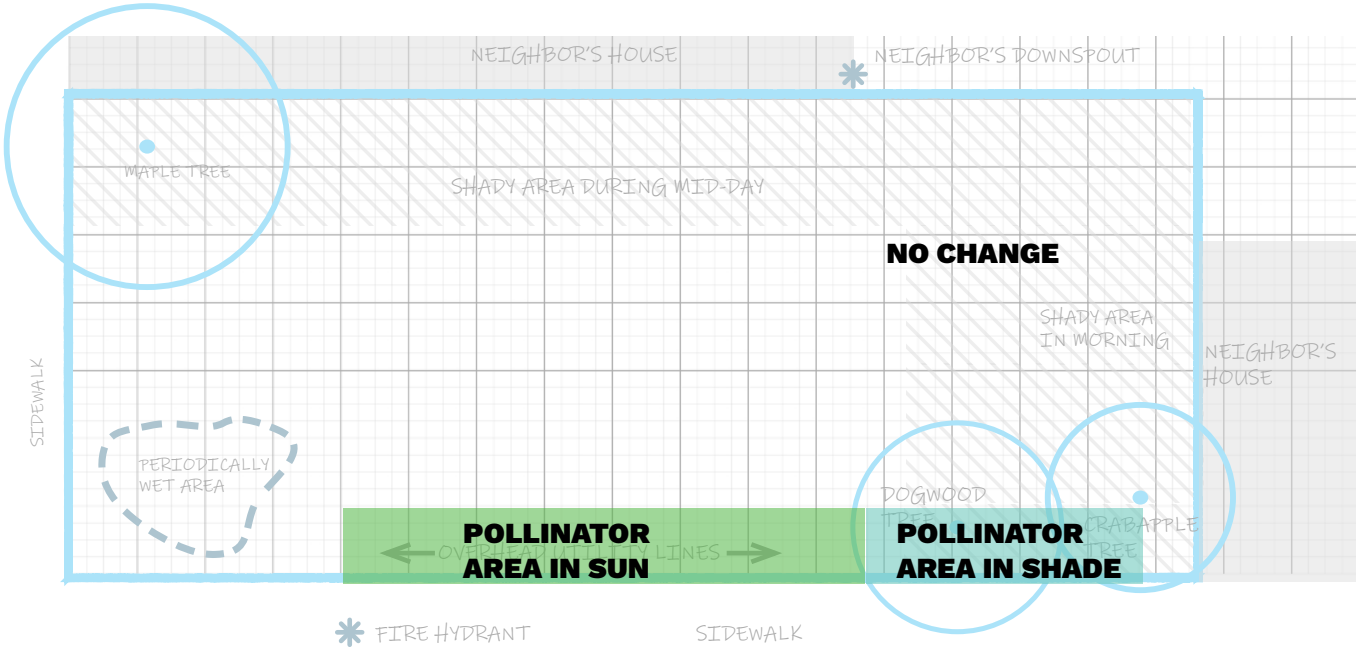
How wide is your patch?

SUN

How long and wide is your area in sun?

SHADE

How long and wide is your area in shade?

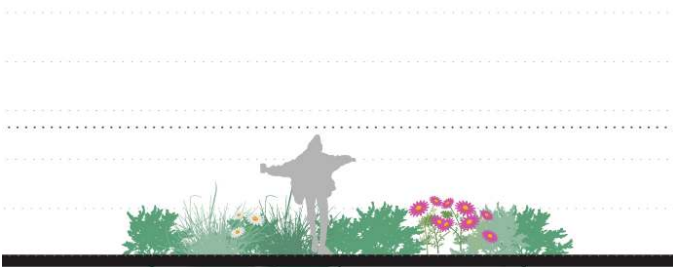




PLANTING PALETTES

Whether you’re dreaming of a cozy corner filled with grasses and wildflowers or picturing a lush space with shrubs and trees, we’ve got you covered. Here are the types of planting that are provided in the workbook. Pick the one that is best suited to you and your site.

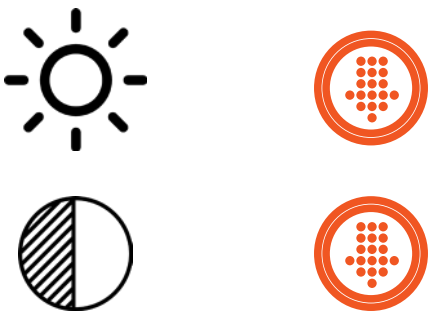
Note the dotted line in the sections below, they indicate 6’, or eye-level. Be cognisant of if you want to obstruct views, or keep them open.



native grasses + wildflowers

Well-suited for smaller spaces. Ideal for promoting biodiversity and supporting pollinators.

Are you in Sun or Shade? Click the arrow below for the plant list!



native grasses, wildflowers + shrubs

This trio is eco-friendly, low-maintenance, and a year-round haven for pollinators. Your garden? A lively, year round private sanctuary! .

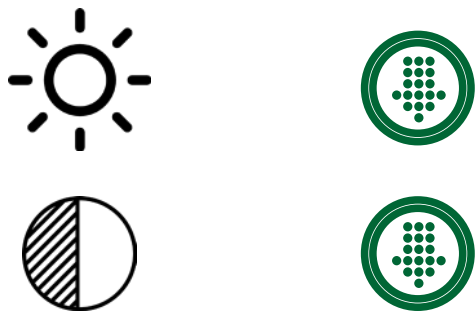
Are you in Sun or Shade? Click the arrow below for the plant list!



native grasses, wildflowers + flowering trees

Easy, beautiful, and low-maintenance in larger areas—your recipe for a vibrant garden retreat

Are you in Sun or Shade? Click the arrow below for the plant list!



native grasses, wildflowers, shrubs + flowering trees

Creates a full-on habitat, offers a cozy home for wildlife, and amps up the overall resilience A lively, year round private sanctuary!

Are you in Sun or Shade? Click the arrow below for the plant list!





Grasses and
wildflowers

Why choose just Native wildflowers and grasses?



Water-Wise Choice: An eco-conscious alternative to lawns, these natives require less water, fertilizer, and mowing.



Sun-Loving Marvels: Perfect for sun-drenched areas, these plants thrive in full sunlight.



Season-Long Color: Enjoy a vibrant display of colors throughout the entire season.



Unobstructed Views: With a height generally under 3 feet, these plants ensure clear, beautiful views of the surrounding area.



Pollinator Paradise: Act as a delightful buffet for pollinators, offering pollen and nectar from flowers and seeds from grasses as a food source.



Initial Effort, Endless Rewards: While the initial maintenance might be a bit more involved, the long-term rewards for your garden and local pollinators are abundant!

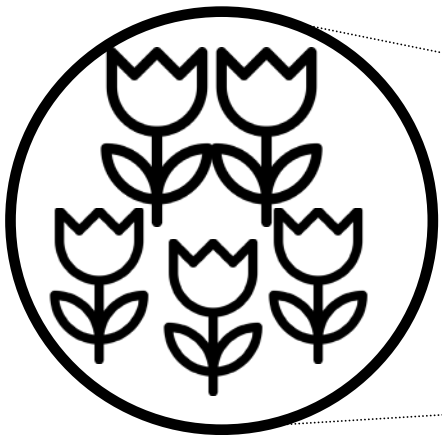
Get ready for a garden that's both visually stunning and a haven for our buzzing friends.



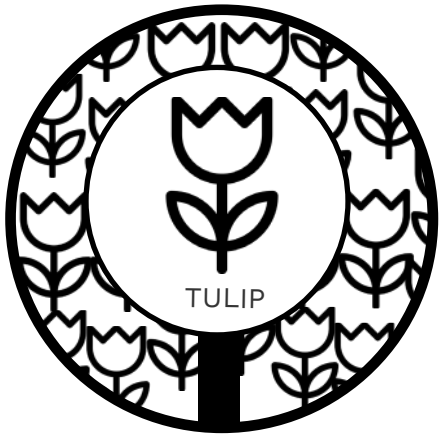
Grasses and
wildflowers

EXAMPLE PLANTING PLAN

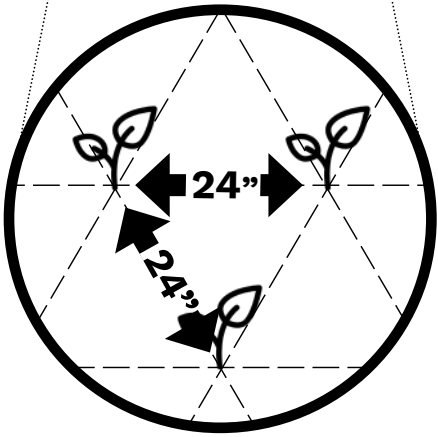
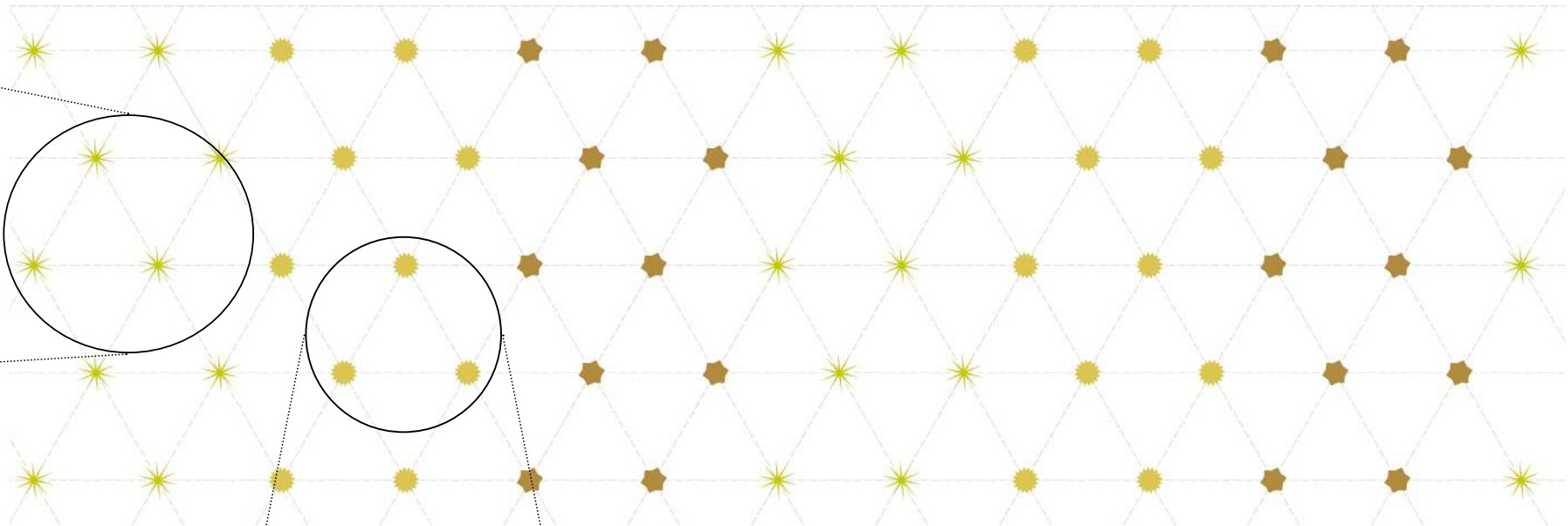
NOTE: You will have a different size than this area, this is an example planting plan for a suggestion of where to plant your grasses and wildflowers.. Each color is a different plant, based on what you end up with from your plant calculator.



Plant your grasses and
wildflowers in groups, at a
minimum of 4-5 in a group



Add a sign to your plants!



Plant your grasses and wildflowers in
triangle formation, 24" apart



After planting, add 3" of
mulch to keep weeds at
bay



Grasses Wildflowers
+ Shrubs

Why add shrubs to the wildflowers and grasses?



Pollinator Paradise

Elevate your garden into a buzzing haven for our insect pals – they'll thank you for the five-star dining and cozy shelters!



Chic, Subdued Style

While it may not scream technicolor all season, it's the Audrey Hepburn of gardens – subtle, classic, and always in vogue.

Get ready for a bit more height, like the garden's own red carpet, with most shrubs under 4'.



Hide and Chic

Need to cover up an eyesore? This palette is your garden's fashion statement – perfect for screening unsightly views!



Maintenance Lite:

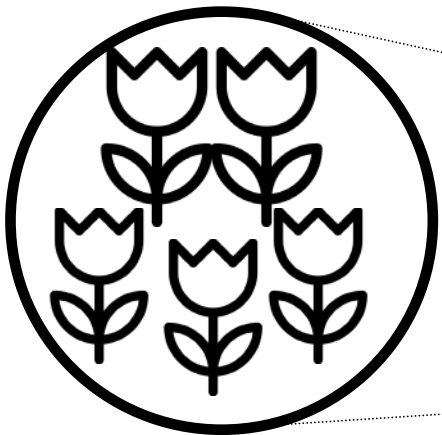
Shrubs are less upkeep than the diva grasses and wildflowers – it's the low-maintenance friend who's always up for a good time. Sprinkle a little pruning magic in year 3-4 to keep things neat and tidy. It's like giving your garden a spa day! Check the Maintenance Notes at the end of the book.



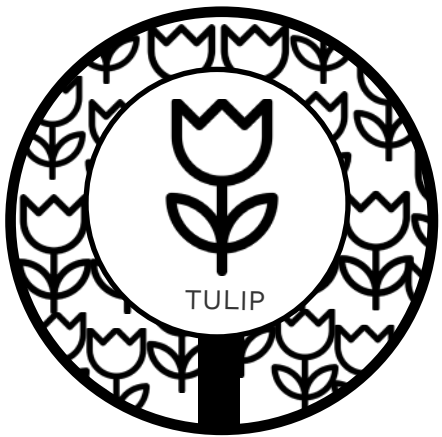
Grasses Wildflowers
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EXAMPLE PLANTING PLAN

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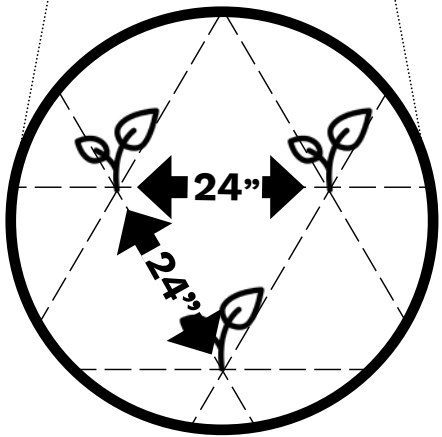
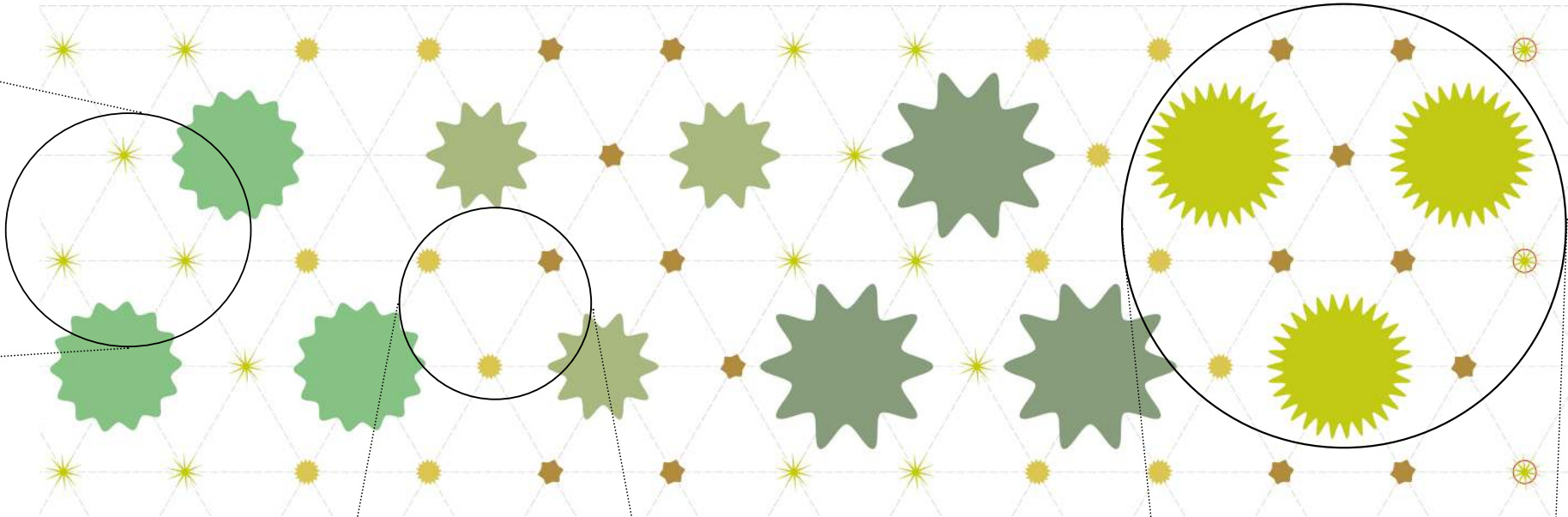


Plant your grasses and wildflowers in groups, at a minimum of 4-5 in a group

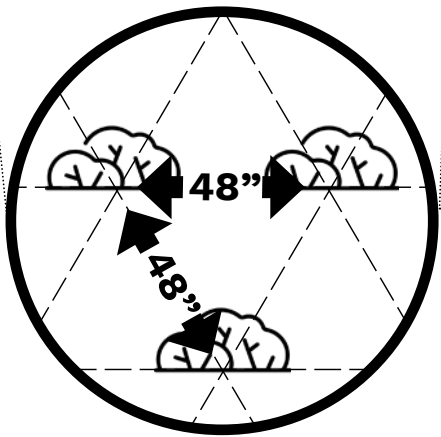


Add a sign to your plants!

 TIP: CLICK FOR
A PRODUCT WE LOVE!



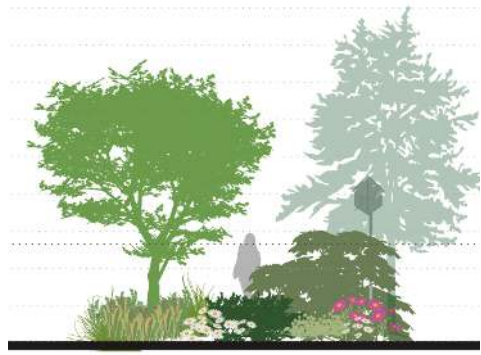
Plant your grasses and wildflowers in triangle formation, 24" apart



Plant your shrubs in a triangle formation, 48" apart
Place them in areas that you might want some shelter or sheild a view.



After planting, add 3" of mulch to keep weeds at bay



Grasses Wildflowers,
Shrubs + Trees

Planting native flowering trees is like giving your garden a burst of local beauty and a myriad of benefits. Here’s why they’re a fantastic addition to any landscape:



Local Charm Native flowering trees bring a touch of local elegance to your garden.



Wildlife Haven Attract birds, bees, and butterflies, creating a lively ecosystem.



Low-Maintenance Stars Resilient to local conditions, they’re easy to care for once established.



Water-Wise Adapted to local rainfall, these trees are eco-friendly and efficient with water.



Year-Round Beauty Blossoms change with the seasons, ensuring a vibrant garden all year.



Pest-Resistant Allies Natural defenses reduce the need for pest control.



Soil Stabilizers Robust roots prevent soil erosion, promoting a healthier garden.

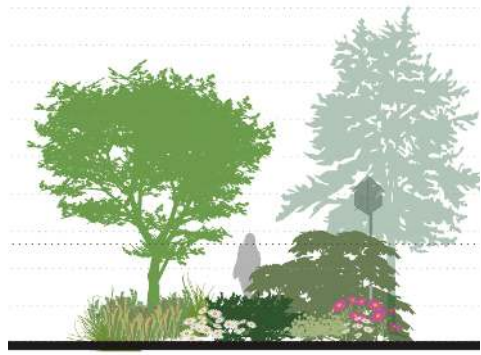


Climate Helpers Contribute to the fight against climate change through carbon sequestration.



Cultural Connection Some trees may have local cultural or historical significance.

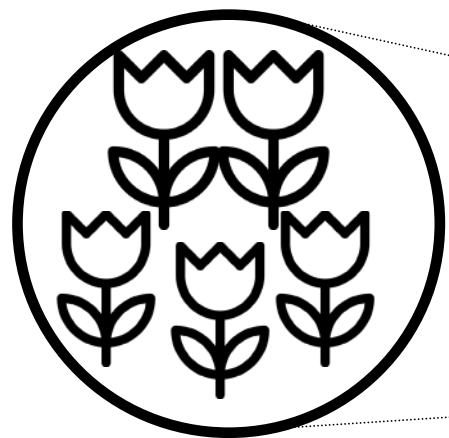
In a nutshell, native flowering trees are your garden’s local VIPs – easy, beautiful, and beneficial!



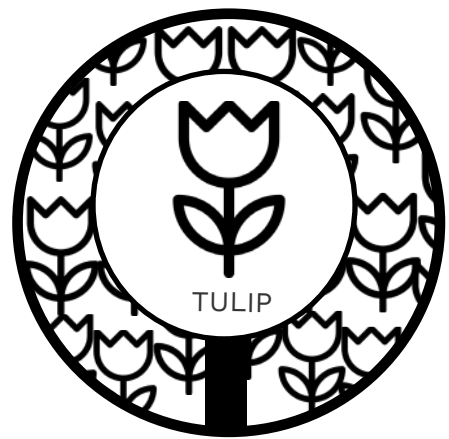
Grasses Wildflowers,
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EXAMPLE PLANTING PLAN

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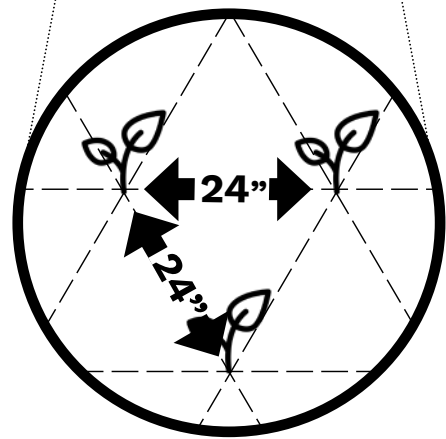
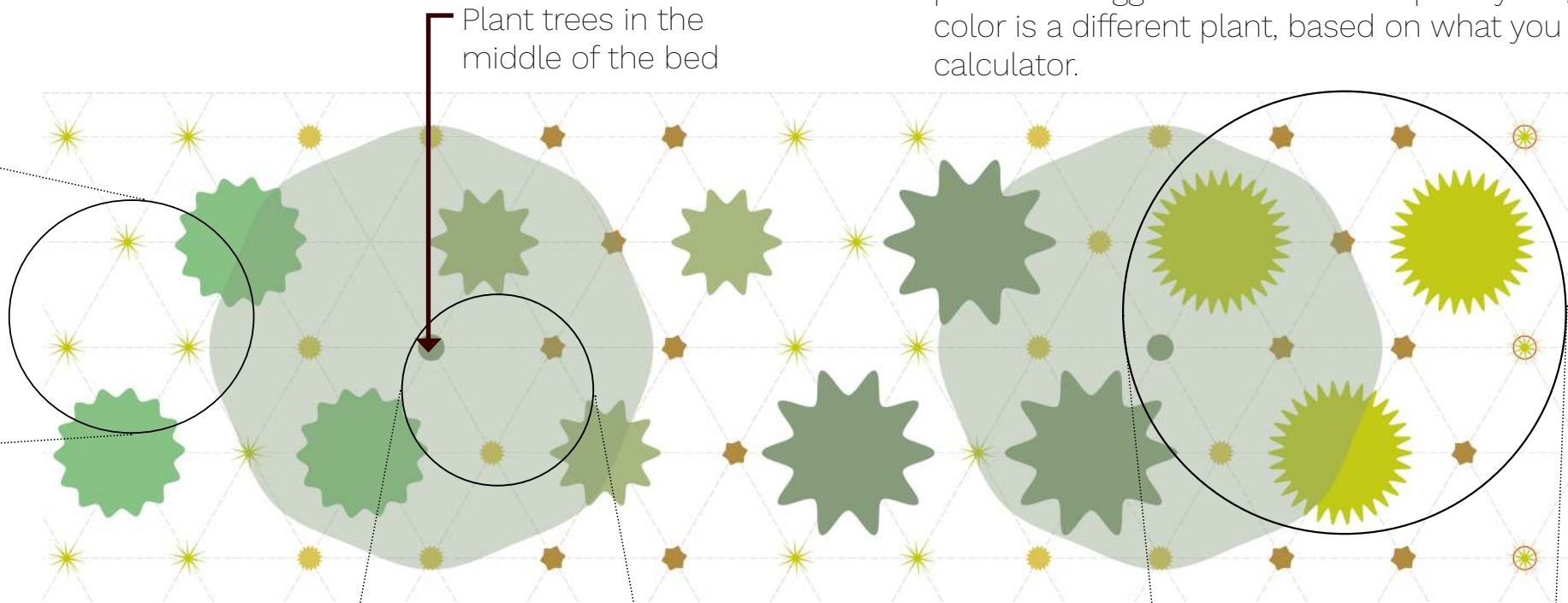


Plant your grasses and wildflowers in groups, at a minimum of 4-5 in a group

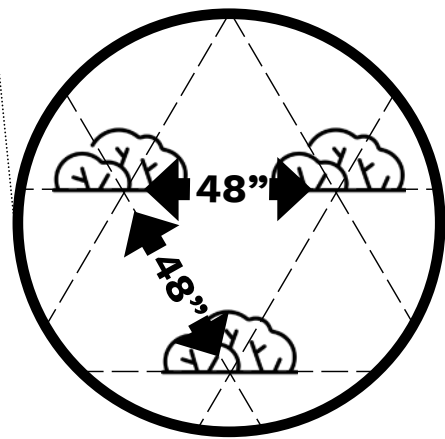


Add a sign to your plants!

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A PRODUCT WE LOVE!



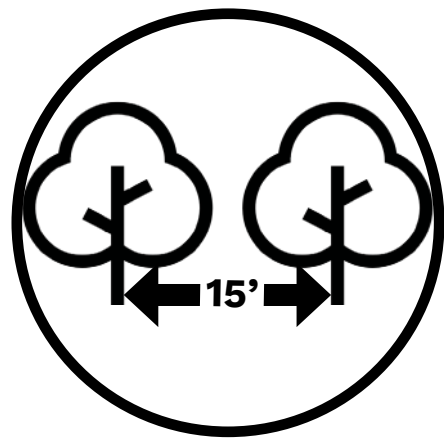
Plant your grasses and wildflowers in triangle formation, 24" apart



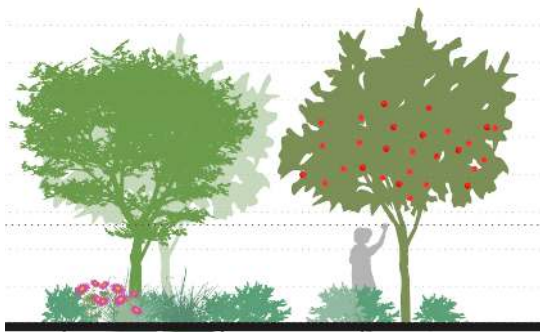
Plant your shrubs in a triangle formation, 48" apart
Place them in areas that you might want some shelter or sheild a view.



After planting, add 3" of mulch to keep weeds at bay



Plant your trees 15' apart



Grasses Wildflowers + Trees

Planting native trees is like giving your garden a burst of local beauty and a myriad of benefits. Here's why native trees are a fantastic addition to the benefits of just wildflowers:



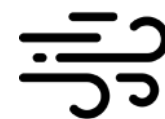
Local Elegance Native trees bring a sense of local charm and elegance to your landscape, perfectly suited to the natural character of your region.



Wildlife Sanctuary Like native wildflowers, native trees provide habitat and food for local wildlife, enhancing the biodiversity of your garden.



Climate Resilience Native trees are adapted to local climate conditions, making them more resilient to extreme weather events and changing climates.



Air Quality Improvements Trees contribute to better air quality by absorbing pollutants and releasing oxygen, promoting a healthier environment.

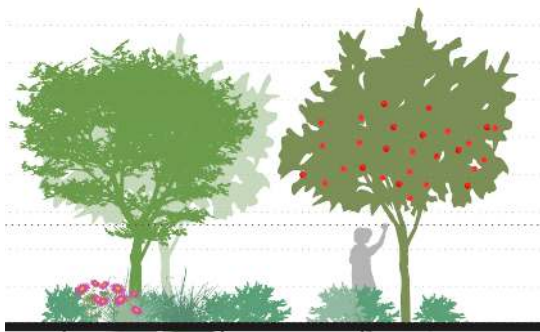


Carbon Sequestration Native trees play a crucial role in capturing and storing carbon dioxide, helping mitigate the effects of climate change.



Visual Clarity A little shade with a carpet under it, what could be better while keeping visibility over the whole site open

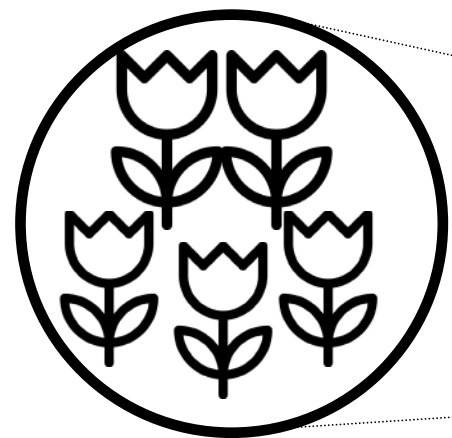
By focusing on native wildflowers and trees, you're not just creating a visually stunning garden but also fostering a sustainable and resilient ecosystem. It's like inviting the best of your local environment to thrive right in your own neighborhood.



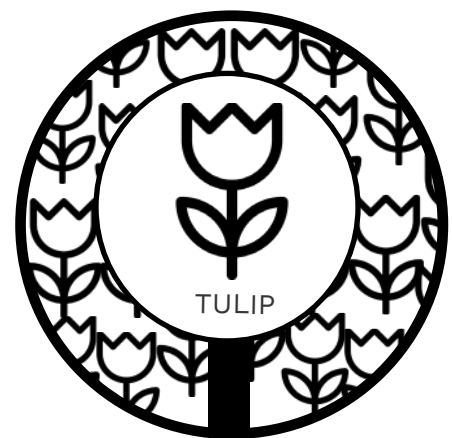
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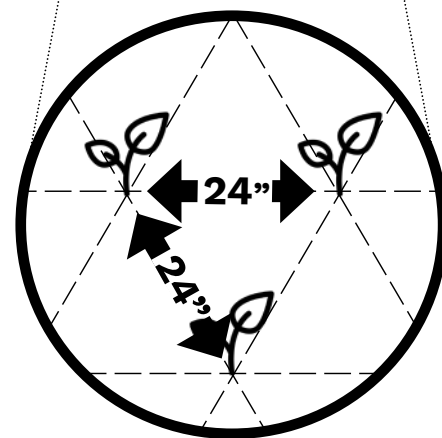
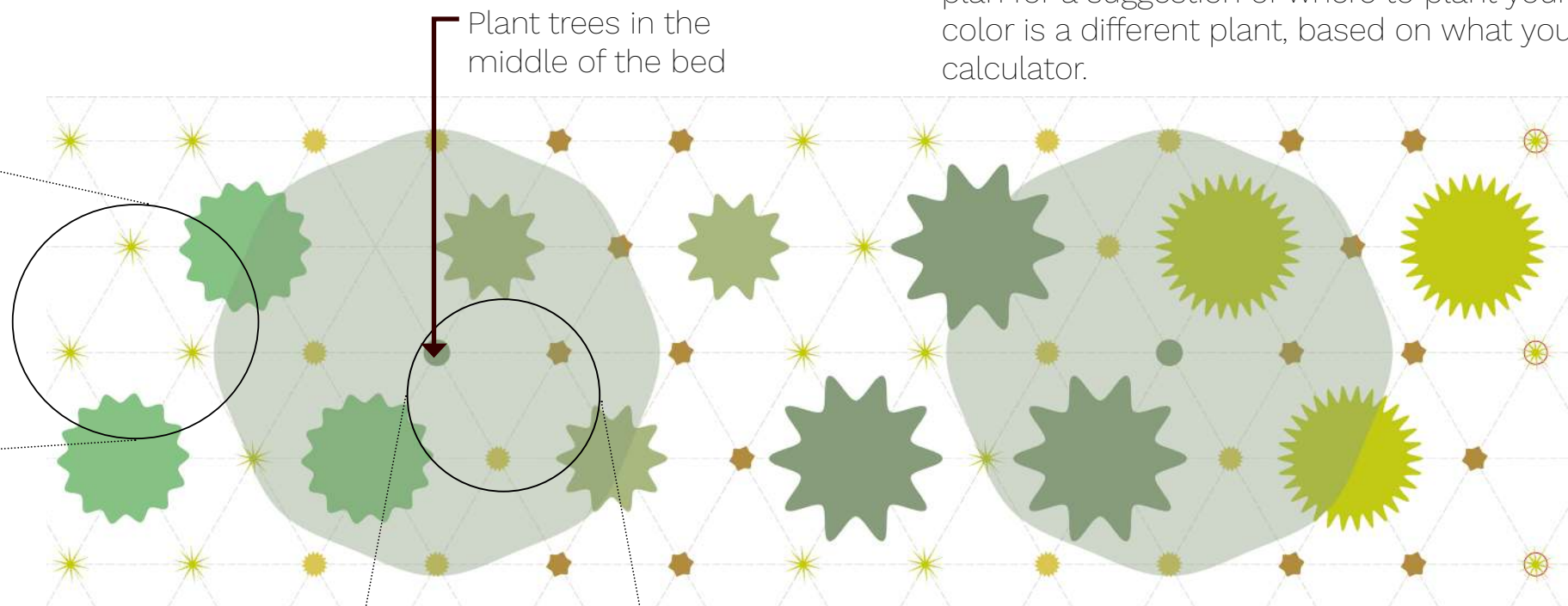


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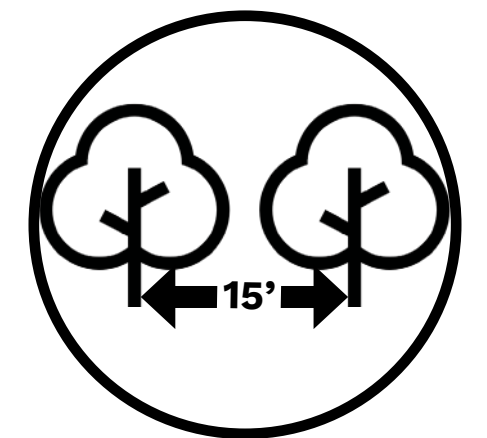
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Plant your grasses and wildflowers in triangle formation, 24" apart



After planting, add 3" of mulch to keep weeds at bay



Plant your trees 15' apart

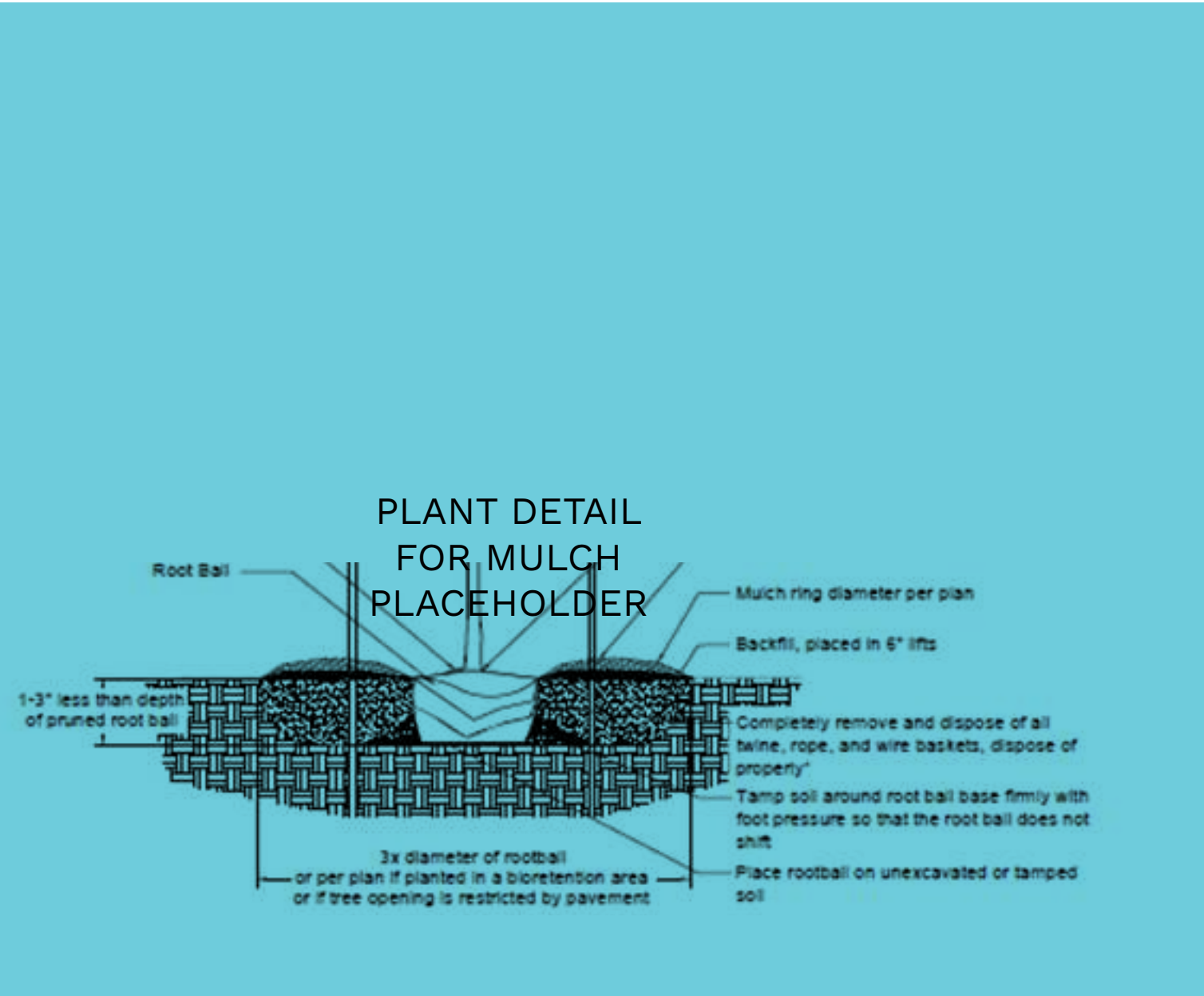
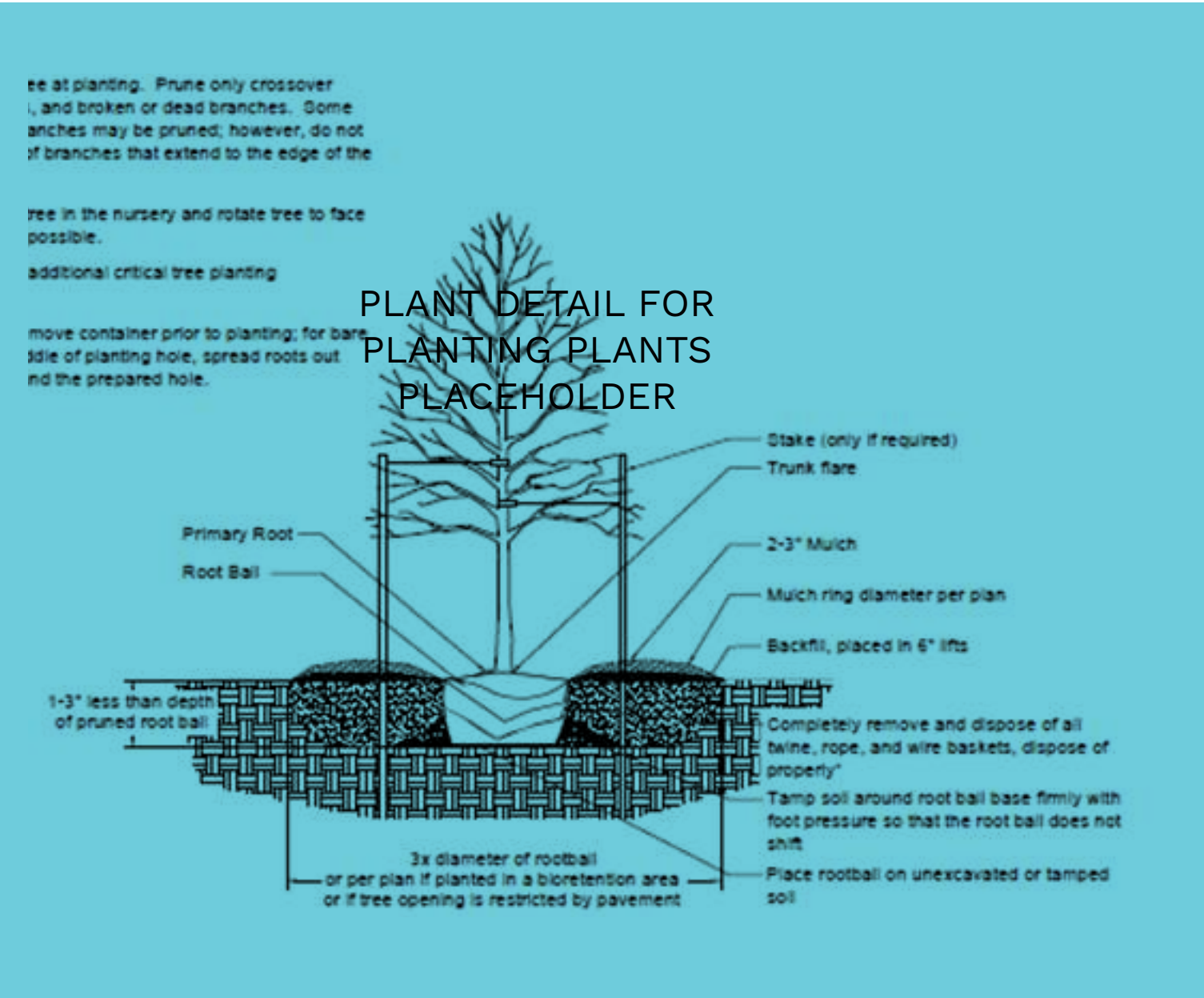


GENERAL PLANTING NOTES

How to unearth plants: Video link

How to plant a tree: Video link

How to deal with a root bound tree: Video link





MAINTENANCE NOTES

First Season:

Water thoroughly: Provide 1” of water weekly during the first season.
Weed Identification: Use BBQ sticks to mark undesirable weeds and remove them.

Second Season and On:

Professional Consultation: Seek professional advice 2-3 times a year from a gardener or PIAT team for a planting review.
Habitat Expansion: Add plants as needed and share extra plants with the community to enhance habitat diversity.
Winter Arborist: Hire an arborist in winter to collaborate with the community for shrub and tree pruning.

Community Maintenance:

Perennial Cutback: Trim perennials to a minimum of 3” above soil between April 1st and May 1st.
Winter Replacements: Replace plants that haven’t survived the winter.
Leaf Mold Replenishment: Add leaf mold only in disturbed/bare soil areas.
Monthly Spot Weeding: Perform monthly spot weeding to maintain plant health.
Drought Watering: Water during prolonged droughts (no rain for >2 weeks).

Educational + Identification Signs

Identify you plants for ease of maintenance, use an image so that anyone will know what a weed is and what isn’t.
Enhance the experience with educational signs placed at the middle of each plant group or at the base of trees.
Provide information on the plant/pollinator relationship and identification characteristics for an engaging landscape.



ARE YOU READY?

Congratulations for completing the Planting Workbook. Below is a summary of what you have done. Please check off each step to ensure you have completed them before moving on.

☐ **TYPE OF PLANTING**

GRASSES, SHRUBS, TREES?

☐ **SIZE OF BED**

YOU KNOW HOW BIG OF AN AREA YOU WILL PLANT, AND IF IT IS IN SUN OR SHADE

☐ **PLANT CHOICE**

PLANT CALCULATOR, PLANT LIST

☐ **MAINTENANCE NOTES**

YOU HAVE REVIEWED THE MAINTENANCE NOTES



DOWNLOAD
THE SUSTAIN
WORKBOOK

Check out the Sustain Workbook for parks, while you might not need it for activities or events, there are some great planting maintenance tips in there!